

Figure 21: Cartoon, India, *20-11-1909*

By now, even Bharati must have realized that SSNCo was a lost cause. There were other immediate worries as well. As the government let loose repression on the Swadeshi agitators, Bharati would have to soon close down his papers in the face of the draconian Indian Press Act.

⚓

Despite the intermittent flickering of hope, 1909 had ended as it had begun —dismally. The steamers continued to be laid up. The minor turnaround with the *Lawoe* plying the coast had been little more than a mirage. A subhead of *Amrita Bazar Patrika*'s report said it all: 'A Year of Heavy Loss.'[131]